

Malleable Penile Implant

WARWIKI

Patient Information · A bendable implant for erection problems

A malleable (bendable) penile implant is a pair of firm rods placed inside the penis. It is for men whose erection problems have not improved with pills, injections or other treatments. There is no pump. You bend the penis up to have sex and down to hide it.

About This Procedure

The surgeon places one bendable rod in each of the two erection chambers of the penis. The penis stays firm all the time. You move it by hand:

- Bend it **up** to have sex
- Bend it **down** to hide it under clothing

It is the simplest implant to use. It can be a good choice if working a pump would be hard, for example if your hands are weak or stiff. It has no fluid parts to leak, but it can still break or need a repair.

Benefits and Risks in Numbers

1–3 in 100

get an infection after a first implant (higher with diabetes or a repeat operation)

1 in 7

need another operation to repair or remove it within 5 years

1 in 13

men in one study later switched to an inflatable implant

Numbers are averages from published studies. Your own risk may differ; ask your team.

What to Know Before You Decide

- **It is permanent.** After surgery, natural erections, pills and injections no longer work. The implant becomes how you get an erection.
- **Feeling and orgasm:** your desire and orgasm stay. Urination and ejaculation usually do not change.
- **It feels different.** The penis may seem shorter or less sensitive than your natural erections were. The head of the penis does not get firm. It will not make the penis longer.
- **It is always firm,** so it can be harder to hide than the inflatable type.

Learn the Terms

Erectile dysfunction (ED)

Trouble getting or keeping an erection firm enough for sex.

Penile implant

A device placed in the penis so you can have sex when other treatments have not worked.

Malleable

Bendable. The rods keep the penis firm, and you position it by hand.

Inflatable implant

The other main type. You squeeze a pump to fill it and press a release to empty it.

Erosion

When part of an implant wears through the skin or the urine tube. It needs care from your team.

Spinal anesthesia

A numbing shot in the back so you feel nothing from the waist down.

Will it hurt? You will be asleep or numb during surgery, so you feel nothing. Afterward, expect soreness, swelling and bruising of the penis and scrotum for a couple of weeks. Most men go home the same day or the next morning.

Weeks 1-2

Swelling and bruising. Support, ice and pain medicine.

Until cleared

No sex. Keep the cut clean and dry.

Weeks 4-6

Check visit. Learn to position it. Sex once cleared.

After that

See your team for regular implant checks.

How to Get Ready

- Follow your surgery instructions about eating, drinking and which medicines to stop, including blood thinners.
- Preventing infection matters most.** Any infection, including a urine infection, is treated first. You will wash with antiseptic soap and get antibiotics.
- Stop smoking and vaping.** If you have diabetes, get your blood sugar under good control. Both lower the infection risk.

Tell your team ahead of time if you:

- Have diabetes or any problem with wound healing
- Have had pelvic or penile surgery, radiation, or an earlier implant

What Happens During Surgery

- 1 You get antibiotics and anesthesia: general, spinal, or numbing medicine with sedation.
- 2 Through one small cut, the surgeon places a bendable rod in each erection chamber. There is no pump or reservoir.
- 3 The cut is closed. You may have a catheter for a short time.

Keep your implant card. Show it before any MRI scan.

Call the office that did your surgery if you have:

- A temperature of **100.4 °F (38 °C)** or higher, or chills
- Redness, swelling or pain that is getting worse, or fluid leaking from the cut
- Skin over the penis that looks thin, shiny or broken

Go to an emergency department if:

- You cannot urinate
- The penis turns dark, cold or very painful
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. Bend it up for sex and down to hide it. There is no pump to learn.
2. It is permanent, and the penis may feel shorter or less sensitive than before.
3. Preventing infection matters most. No sex until your team clears you.